

FURTHER MECHANICS / WORK, ENERGY AND POWER

Elastic Potential Energy

Questions by topic

10 questions · 96 marks

Instructions

Unless a question states otherwise, take $g = 9.8 \text{ m s}^{-2}$ wherever a numerical value of g is required. Solutions also give final answers for $g = 10 \text{ m s}^{-2}$ where these differ.

Questions

Question 1	5 marks	2
Question 2	10 marks	3
Question 3	5 marks	4
Question 4	7 marks	5
Question 5	15 marks	6
Question 6	11 marks	7
Question 7	11 marks	8
Question 8	12 marks	9
Question 9	11 marks	10
Question 10	9 marks	11

1. One end of a light elastic string, of natural length $2a$ and modulus of elasticity $2mg$, is attached to a fixed point O . The other end of the string is attached to a particle P of mass m . The string is vertical with P directly above O . The particle P is pulled vertically upwards until the extension of the string is $2a$. The particle P is then released from rest.

(a) Find the speed of P when it is at a distance $\frac{3}{2}a$ above O . [3]

(b) Find the initial acceleration of P when it is released from rest. [2]

- 2.** A light elastic string has natural length 2.5 metres and modulus of elasticity 15 newtons.

One end of the elastic string is attached to a particle of mass 0.75 kg.

The other end of the elastic string is attached to a fixed point O .

The particle is released from rest at a point A , which is 2.9 metres vertically below O .

- (a) Calculate the elastic potential energy stored in the string when the particle is at A . [2]
- (b) The point B is 4.0 metres vertically below O .
Calculate the gravitational potential energy lost by the particle as it moves from A to B . [2]
- (c) Find the speed of the particle at B . [3]
- (d) The point C is 3.3 metres vertically below O .
Explain, showing any calculations that you make, why the speed of the particle is increasing the first time that the particle is at C . [3]

3. A particle P of mass m is attached to one end of a light elastic string of natural length a and modulus $2mg$. The other end of the string is attached to a fixed point O on a rough plane inclined at 30° to the horizontal.

The string lies along a line of greatest slope, with O below P . The particle is initially at rest on the plane with the string at its natural length.

The coefficient of friction between P and the plane is $\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$.

The particle is projected up the plane, away from O , with speed $\sqrt{\frac{3ga}{2}}$.

Find the greatest extension of the string during the subsequent motion.

[5]

4. The points A and B are at the same horizontal level and are $24a$ apart. The ends of a light elastic string, of natural length $18a$ and modulus of elasticity λ , are attached to A and B . A particle P of mass m is attached to the midpoint of the string. The system is in equilibrium with P at a distance $5a$ below M , the midpoint of AB .

(a) Find λ in terms of m and g . [3]

The particle P is pulled down vertically and released from rest from a position $9a$ below M .

(b) Find, in terms of a and g , the speed of P as it passes through its equilibrium position. [4]

5. A light elastic string has natural length $3a$ and modulus of elasticity $9mg$. One end of the string is attached to a fixed point O . A particle P of mass m is attached to the other end. The particle hangs freely in equilibrium at the point E , vertically below O .

(a) Find the length OE . [4]

The particle is then pulled vertically downwards from E to a point A , where $OA = \frac{16a}{3}$, and released from rest.

The resistance to the motion of P is a constant force of magnitude $\frac{1}{4}mg$.

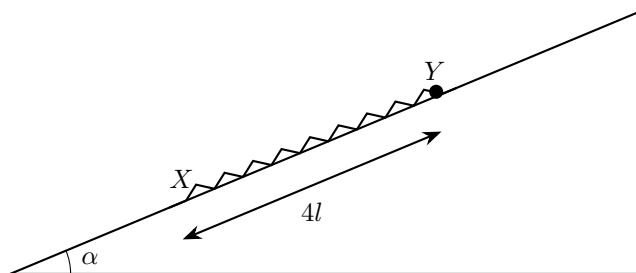
(b) Find, in terms of a and g , the speed of P as it passes through E . [7]

The particle is now held at O and released from rest.

The resistance to the motion of P is again a constant force of magnitude $\frac{1}{4}mg$.

The speed of P is greatest when it is at the point B .

(c) Find the distance OB . [4]



6. A light elastic spring has natural length $2l$ and modulus of elasticity mg . One end of the spring is attached to a fixed point X on a rough inclined plane. The other end is attached to a package P of mass m .

The plane is inclined to the horizontal at an angle α where

$$\tan \alpha = \frac{5}{12}$$

The package is initially held at the point Y on the plane, where $XY = 4l$. The point Y is higher than X and XY is a line of greatest slope of the plane, as shown. The package is released from rest at Y and moves down the plane.

The coefficient of friction between P and the plane is $\frac{1}{4}$.

By modelling P as a particle,

- (a) show that the acceleration of P at the instant when it is released is

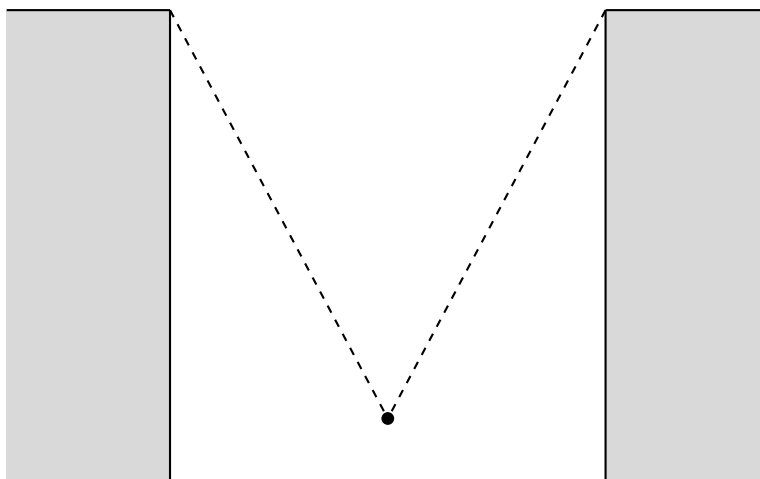
$$\frac{15}{13}g$$

down the plane.

[5]

- (b) find, in terms of g and l , the speed of P at the instant when the spring first regains its natural length.

[6]



7. A stunt performer is attached to two identical light elastic cords. One end of each cord is fixed to opposite sides of the rim of a vertical shaft, as shown in the diagram above.

The performer has mass 80 kg and is modelled as a particle. Initially the performer is held at rest at the centre of the shaft, 7 metres above the floor. The shaft is 52 metres deep and 48 metres wide. Each elastic cord has natural length 30 metres and modulus of elasticity 3150 N .

The performer is released from rest.

- (a) Show that the speed of the performer when the cords first become slack is 25 m s^{-1} correct to two significant figures. [6]
- (b) Determine whether the performer is moving up or down when the cords become taut again. [5]

8. A spring of natural length a is suspended from a fixed point A . A package P of mass m is attached to the lower end of the spring.

The package is initially at the point B , vertically below A , where $AB = a$.

The package is projected vertically downwards from B with speed $\sqrt{ag}$.

It first comes to instantaneous rest at the point C , where $AC = 2a$.

Air resistance is modelled as negligible. By modelling the spring as light and modelling P as a particle,

- (a) show that the modulus of elasticity of the spring is $3mg$ [5]
- (b) (i) Show that P attains its maximum speed when the extension of the spring is $\frac{1}{3}a$ [2]
(ii) Hence find the maximum speed, giving your answer in terms of a and g . [4]
- (c) In reality, the spring is not light.
State one way in which this would affect your energy equation in part (b). [1]

9. A light elastic string with natural length l and modulus of elasticity kmg has one end attached to a fixed point A on a rough inclined plane. The other end of the string is attached to a package of mass m . The plane is inclined at an angle θ to the horizontal, where

$$\tan \theta = \frac{3}{4}$$

The package is initially held at the point C on a line of greatest slope of the plane below A , where $AC = 3l$. The package is then projected down the plane with speed $2\sqrt{gl}$ and first comes to rest at the point B , where $AB = 5l$.

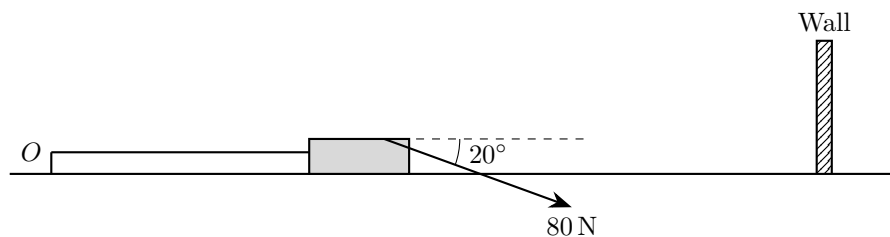
The coefficient of friction between the package and the plane is $\frac{1}{2}$.

By modelling the package as a particle,

- (a) show that

$$k = \frac{2}{5} \quad [6]$$

- (b) find the acceleration of the package at the instant it starts to move back up the plane from the point B . [5]



- 10.** A block of mass 6 kg rests on a rough horizontal surface and is attached to a fixed point O by a light elastic string. Initially the block is at rest 2.4 m from O .

The elastic string has natural length 2 m and modulus of elasticity 80 N .

The coefficient of friction between the block and the surface is 0.25 .

A force of magnitude 80 N is applied to the block towards a vertical wall. The force acts at an angle of 20° below the horizontal, as shown in the diagram.

The block moves in a straight line perpendicular to the wall, and the wall is sufficiently far away that the block does not reach it during the motion considered.

In this question, take $g = 9.8\text{ m s}^{-2}$.

- (a) Show that the block has moved 0.94 m , correct to 2 significant figures, when the forces acting on it are in equilibrium. [4]
- (b) State one limitation of the model. [1]
- (c) Find the maximum speed of the block. [4]